

Amanda Bamford

Senior Software Engineer and Technical Lead with 8+ years of experience designing and delivering backend systems using Java and AWS. Experienced in leading cross-functional squads, building scalable APIs, improving cloud infrastructure, and mentoring engineers. Strong background in distributed systems, CI/CD, observability, and production support in high-availability environments. Passionate about clean architecture, developer productivity, and building resilient systems that solve real user problems.

WORK EXPERIENCE

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING TEAM LEAD, BBC - 2025 - PRESENT

Technical lead for multiple backend squads delivering high-availability services within a large-scale media platform.

Key Contributions:

- Lead cross-functional squads of backend engineers, providing architectural direction and technical oversight.
- Own technical design decisions, ensuring scalability, reliability, and maintainability across services.
- Mentor and line-manage engineers at graduate through senior level, supporting career progression and performance development.
- Drive recruitment, interviewing, and onboarding processes.
- Improve engineering standards through code reviews, knowledge sharing, and best practice adoption.
- Collaborate with product and delivery stakeholders to align technical delivery with business priorities.
- Assessed new technologies and led the formal approval process.

Core Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, TypeScript, OAuth2, CI/CD pipelines, AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, RDS, CloudWatch, ACM, Systems Manager, EventBridge, Cost Management, CDK & CloudFormation).

Other Tools: OpenAPI, Postman, Maven, Jenkins, Git, Miro, Jira, Confluence, Slack, Teams.

BACKEND SOFTWARE ENGINEER, BBC - 2022 - 2025

Backend engineer working on cloud-native services in a production AWS environment.

Key Contributions:

- Designed and implemented RESTful services using Java (8/11) and Spring Boot.
- Built and maintained AWS infrastructure using CDK and CloudFormation.
- Developed and configured OAuth2 clients for secure service-to-service communication.
- Performed live production deployments and supported high-availability systems.
- Improved observability through Splunk and Datadog log analysis and monitoring.
- Contributed to CI/CD pipeline improvements using Jenkins and Maven.
- Worked within Agile delivery teams using Jira and collaborative tooling.

Core Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, TypeScript, OAuth2, CI/CD pipelines, AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, RDS, CloudWatch, ACM, Systems Manager, EventBridge, CDK & CloudFormation).

Other Tools: OpenAPI, Postman, Maven, Jenkins, Git, Miro, Jira, Confluence, Slack, Teams.

SOFTWARE ENGINEER, I2 - 2021 - 2022

Continued in the same role following the acquisition of IBM i2 by Harris Computer.

SOFTWARE ENGINEER IBM - 2018 - 2021

Server-side Java engineer working on enterprise intelligence and analytics products (IBM i2).

Key Contributions:

- Designed, implemented, and tested REST and GraphQL APIs in Java 8/11.
- Contributed to backend architecture using Guice dependency injection.
- Worked with DB2 and SQL Server databases.
- Delivered customer-facing defect fixes, including a Severity 1 production issue for a major client.
- Rapidly onboarded onto unfamiliar code areas to deliver critical fixes two days ahead of schedule.
- Adapted development plans to accommodate evolving customer requirements.
- Maintained developer tooling and documentation (Markdown, Mermaid).
- Delivered product demonstrations to customers, government officials, and press.
- Organised social events such as: Christmas socials, comedy night, escape rooms and International Women's Day.
- Interviewed and onboarded new graduate and senior employees.

Technologies: Java, Guice, Gradle, SQL (DB2, SQL Server), JSON, XML, Protocol Buffers, Git, Docker

Other Tools: OpenAPI, Postman, Maven, Jenkins, Git, Miro, Jira, Confluence, Slack, Teams.

SOFTWARE ENGINEER, BT - 2017 - 2018

- Graduate software engineering programme.
- Worked on front-end development using Adobe Experience Manager.
- Contributed to Agile team delivery and production releases.

IT SOFTWARE DEVELOPER, IBM - 2015 - 2016

Worked within infrastructure and storage product teams.

- Performance developer within the Spectrum Scale team, ensuring no performance regressions between releases.
- Designed and automated performance test scripts, including automation around SPECsfs tooling.
- Contributed to performance validation for new product features.
- Later moved to Storewize / SVC product testing.
- Collaborated with global teams to validate new functionality.
- Automated elements of hardware-based testing workflows to improve efficiency.

IT ROVER, MMU - 2014 - 2015**PROGRAMMING MENTOR, MMU - 2014 - 2015****RESEARCH ASSISTANT, MMU - 2014 - 2015****RECEPTIONIST, MMU - 2013 - 2014****FUNDRAISING & LOTTERY ADMINISTRATOR, BURY HOSPICE - 2010 - 2013**

EDUCATION

MANCHESTER METROPOLITAN UNIVERSITY - SOFTWARE ENGINEERING BSC, 1ST (98%)
HOLY CROSS COLLEGE - ICT, PSYCHOLOGY, BIOLOGY, CHEMISTRY, EPQ
TOTTINGTON HIGH SCHOOL - GCSES A - C

SKILLS & HOBBIES

I was a finalist in IBM's Call for Code competition. My contribution involved creating a mobile application that synchronised with a backend server for data storage and Watson chatbot communication. I was one of the 14 finalists from hundreds of applications from all over the world.

During my placement at IBM, I actively involved myself in activities external to my usual job role, some of which included: volunteering to help run an assessment centre, educating students during a Lego Robot day, speaking at a WIT event, leading a group of students at the Best Student Recognition Event and being an active member of a patent group.

My hobbies include: sewing, painting, gardening, reading and gaming.